



CLASS ADMIN SOFTWARE, WEB PLATFORM, EVENT MANAGEMENT

# ClassManager is a cloud-based web platform designed to simplify and automate class administration

From dance studios to martial arts academies, ClassManager helps business owners manage bookings, scheduling, billing, and communication - all in one place.

As the Product Designer on the project from 2021 to 2022, I led the end-to-end UX/UI redesign of the platform, collaborating closely with cross-functional teams. My focus was to streamline user flows, redesign a bit UI, create a scalable design system, and reduce the friction that often plagues admin-heavy platforms.

[View the website](#)

## MY ROLE

Product Designer

## DURATION

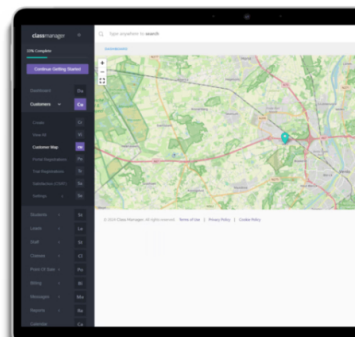
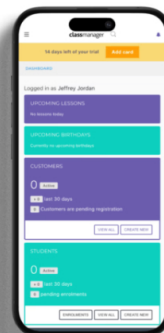
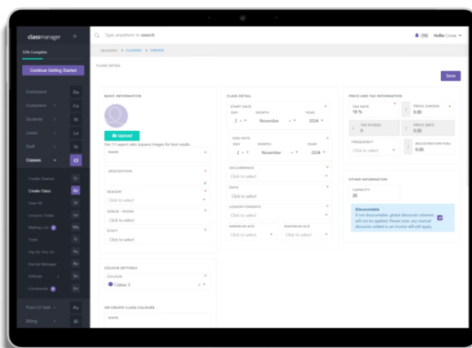
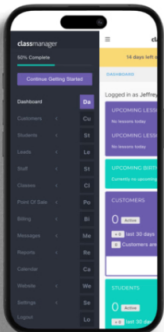
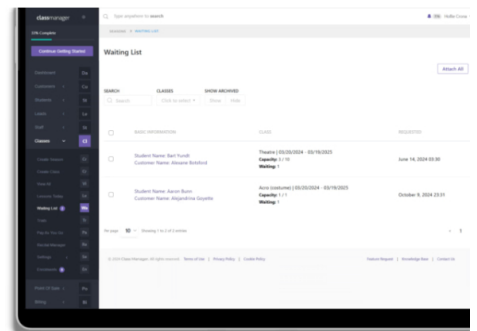
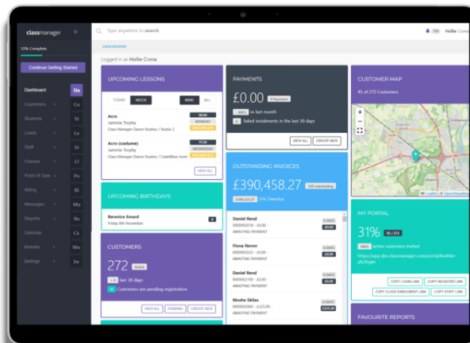
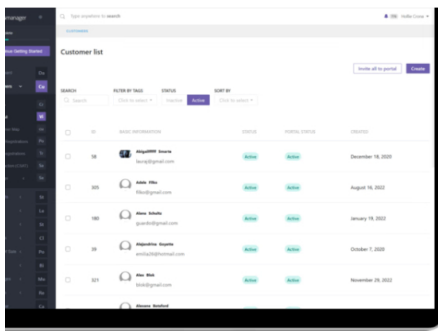
From 2021 - 2022

## TEAM

Backend Developers (3), QA Testers (2), Frontend Developers (2), CEO, Marketing Team.

## SCOPE

Responsive UI, New onboarding experience, Components Library



Overview

Problem

Goal

Solution

Results

Process

## INTRO

### What ClassManager is and why it matters

**ClassManager** is a cloud-based class administration platform built for small to mid-sized sports and activity clubs - including dance studios, swimming schools, gymnastics programs, and martial arts academies. It provides business owners with essential tools to manage bookings, scheduling, payments, staff, and communication in a single, centralized system.

## PROBLEM

### Why the platform needed a redesign

Despite a solid business model, ClassManager was struggling with low user engagement and frequent support tickets. The platform had grown organically, but lacked UX coherence and visual consistency. Users often found onboarding confusing, class setup unintuitive, and day-to-day admin tasks time-consuming.

Competitor platforms were either too expensive or too complex, leaving an opportunity for a solution that felt simple, affordable, and built for real-world workflows.

## GOAL

### What we set out to fix

The goal was to transform ClassManager into a modern, user-centric platform that empowered small business owners to spend less time on admin and more time teaching.

Specifically:

- Reduce onboarding friction and setup time
- Improve task flow clarity for managing classes, students, and billing
- Build a consistent, scalable design system
- Increase product adoption and reduce support requests

## SOLUTION

### How I redesigned the experience

I approached the redesign with a systems-thinking mindset - combining foundational UX improvements with modular UI development. I introduced a new onboarding flow with step-based progress tracking, created a component-based UI kit using Tailwind CSS and Vue.js, and simplified key flows like creating classes, managing students, and handling billing.

And I focused on clear visual hierarchy, mobile responsiveness, and contextual guidance to improve usability across devices.

## RESULTS & OUTCOME

### What changed after the redesign

Users reported smoother navigation, less confusion, and a significant reduction in their day-to-day admin workload. ClassManager became an intuitive, business-friendly tool that felt like it was built for them - not against them.

Facebook

Here's what we achieved together with our team:

**46%**

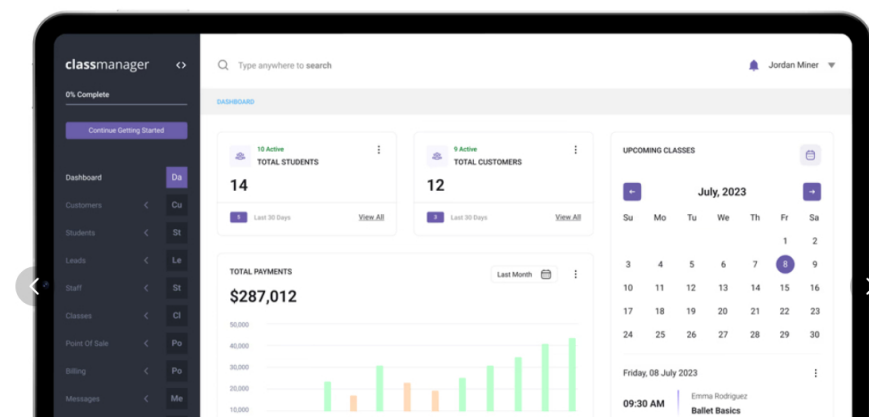
Faster onboarding

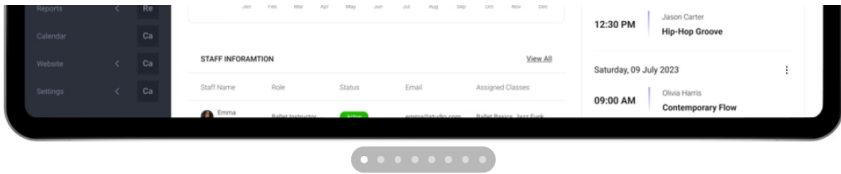
**~25%**

Fewer support issues

**~35%**

Faster admin tasks





PROCESS

How I uncovered what users truly needed

To understand the real-world struggles users faced, I conducted qualitative interviews with instructors, administrators, and business owners who actively used ClassManager. These conversations revealed recurring patterns, including confusion around form logic, unclear navigation, and difficulty managing class capacity. I supplemented this with a usability audit and heuristic evaluation, which confirmed critical friction points. Additionally, I reviewed competitor platforms to identify best practices in calendar management, student profiles, and notification flows. These insights helped prioritize design goals and informed every decision in the following stages.

COMPETITIVE RESEARCH

What the market was missing

During this phase, I compared ClassManager to competitors like Mindbody, Brightwheel, and Jackrabbit Dance. Most tools were either overpriced or overloaded with features irrelevant to small businesses. Very few were mobile-optimized or automated. These gaps helped me identify an opportunity to build a lightweight, affordable, and focused solution that put user needs first.

| Class_Admin_Software_Competitive_Analysis |                           |                                    |                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Competitor                                | Target Market             | Strengths                          | Weaknesses                                         |
| DreamClass                                | Schools & Institutions    | Customizable for schools           | Complex for small businesses                       |
| Classe365                                 | All-in-One EdTech         | Complete admin suite               | Expensive for startups                             |
| Gradelink                                 | K-12 Schools              | Grading & reports focus            | Limited outside education                          |
| Teach 'n Go                               | Tutoring & Small Classes  | Simple scheduling                  | Lacks advanced features                            |
| Brightwheel                               | Preschools & Childcare    | Childcare-friendly                 | Not suitable for large institutions                |
| Jackrabbit Dance                          | Dance Studios             | Tailored for dance studios         | Limited outside dance niche                        |
| Pike13                                    | Fitness & Wellness        | Strong automation features         | Lacks strong community features                    |
| TUIO                                      | Tuition Payments          | Tuition & invoicing focus          | Only for payment processing                        |
| Sawyer                                    | Activity Centers          | Comprehensive marketplace          | Focused on specific activity niches                |
| Alma mis                                  | School Management         | MIS integration                    | High learning curve                                |
| iClassPro                                 | Martial Arts & Sports     | Specialized for martial arts       | Not ideal for general class-based businesses       |
| Teachmint X                               | Online Teaching           | Built for remote education         | Limited to virtual teaching                        |
| ClickMeeting                              | Virtual Meetings          | Web conferencing tools             | Not a class management system                      |
| Jotform                                   | Forms & Bookings          | Strong integration & customization | Too generic for specialized class-based businesses |
| Regpack                                   | Registration & Payments   | Secure payments & enrollments      | Not tailored for class operations                  |
| Vcita                                     | Small Business Management | All-in-one business tools          | Focuses more on small businesses than education    |
| Classter                                  | Higher Education          | Supports multi-campus management   | Higher education focus limits adoption             |
| iGradePlus                                | Grading & Assessments     | Robust grading system              | Limited class scheduling options                   |
| Arlo for training providers               | Professional Training     | Corporate training focus           | B2B-focused, not B2C                               |
| Corsizio                                  | Event-Based Learning      | Event management tools             | Niche event-based, not general use                 |
| Main Street Sites                         | Community & Local Classes | Local business-oriented            | Focuses more on community than structured courses  |
| SmartRec                                  | Recreational Programs     | Outdoor & sports focus             | Limited to recreational activities                 |

From this research, I defined key focus areas for ClassManager: simplicity, affordability, and automation. The ClassManager positioned the platform as an intuitive, cost-effective solution that provided the essential tools for class-based businesses – without unnecessary complexity.

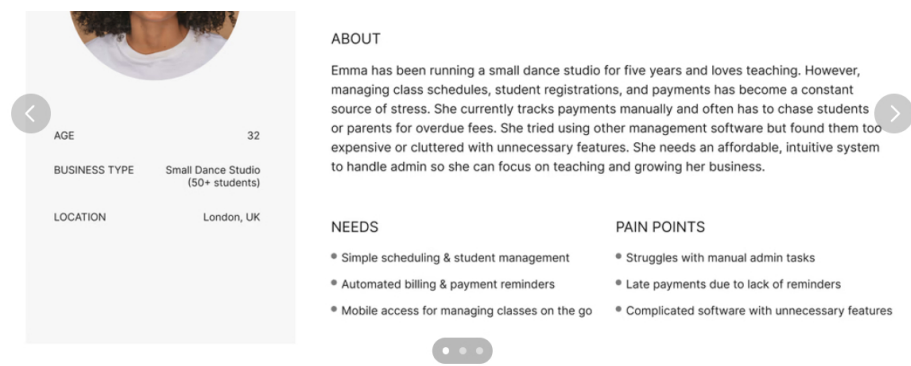
USER PERSONA

Who we were designing for

I created detailed personas to represent our core users. Emma, a dance studio owner, was overwhelmed by constant admin tasks. Mark, a martial arts instructor, struggled with managing classes across venues. Sarah, who ran a swim school, constantly dealt with parent communication and disorganized scheduling. These personas helped ensure we addressed real-world pain points, not imagined ones.



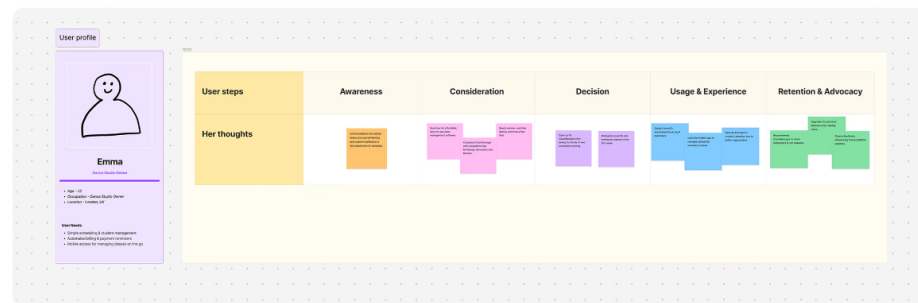
USER PERSONA 1  
**Emma Thompson**  
Dance Studio Owner



## USER JOURNEY MAP

### Where the friction was happening

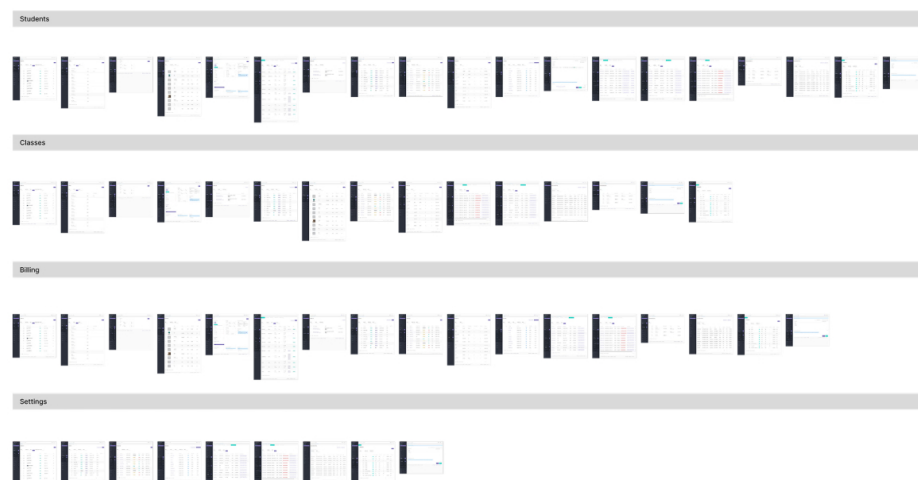
Mapping out Emma's full user journey revealed a system full of friction: from late-night manual reminders to missed payments and last-minute cancellations. She had tried switching to other platforms but found them either too expensive or too complex. This journey map helped us prioritize automation, mobile access, and simplification.



## DESIGN & PROTOTYPING

### How I reshaped the core flows

I started by simplifying core flows like onboarding, class creation, and payment management. I used progressive disclosure, reduced cognitive load, and introduced visual hierarchy so users could focus on one step at a time. The new structure gave users confidence, speed, and clarity, resulting in fewer errors and faster workflows.



## DESIGN & RESULTS

### Guiding new users with confidence

This is the **Onboarding Dashboard**, I designed to guide new users through essential setup steps efficiently. The onboarding system provides a structured, step-by-step checklist, ensuring users complete key tasks like adding customers, linking students, setting up venues, and managing billing.



### Progress Bar (Top Left)

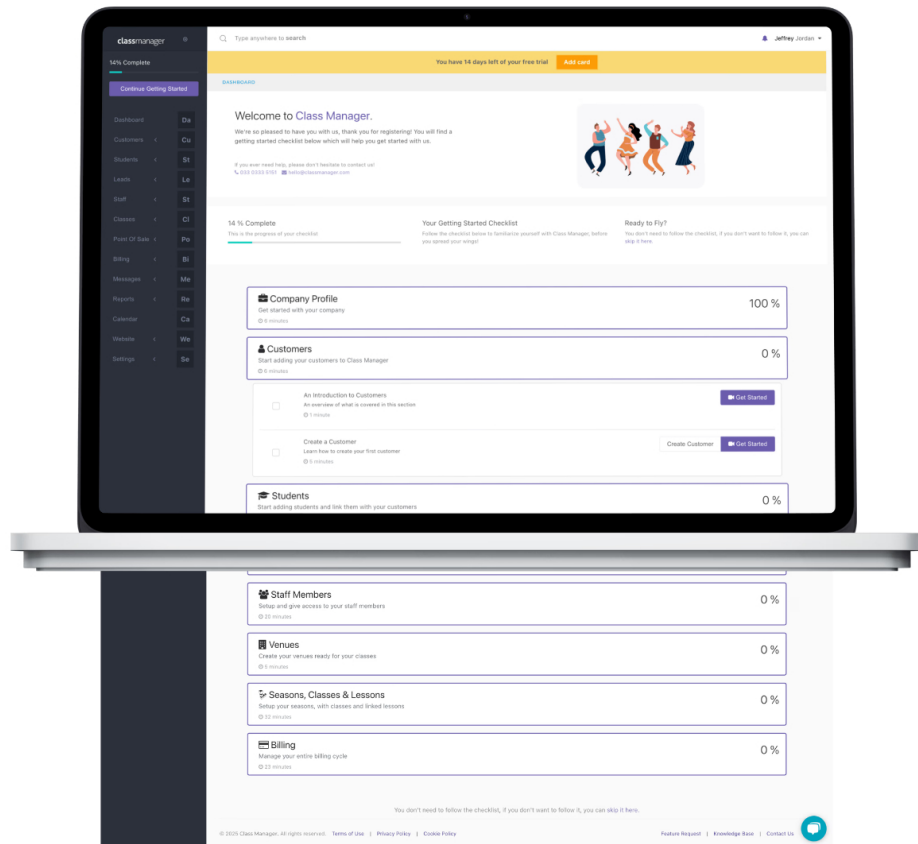
Displays onboarding completion percentage, motivating users to finish setup.

### Task-Based Sections

Divides onboarding into Company Profile, Customers, Students, Staff, Venues, Classes, and Billing, ensuring a guided experience.

### Call-to-Action Buttons (Get Started)

Encourages engagement with an intuitive action-based approach.

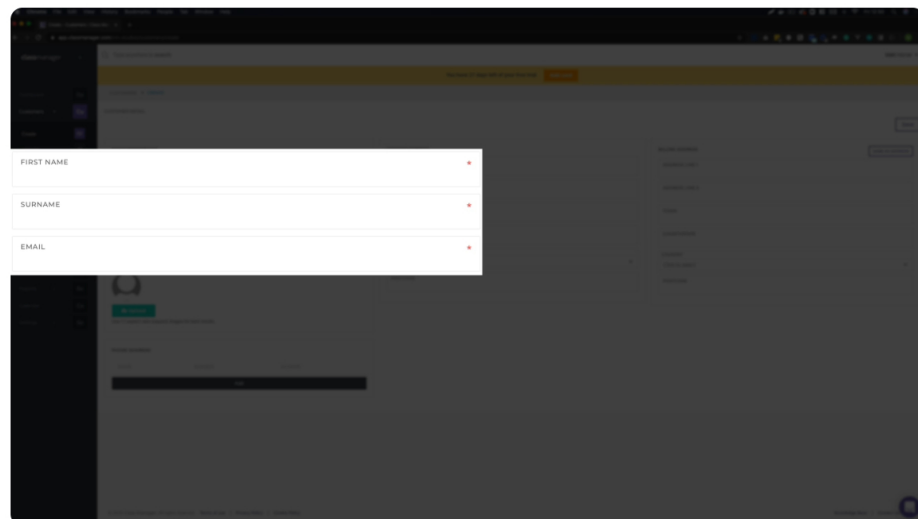


## DESIGN & RESULTS

# Simplifying setup for businesses and clients

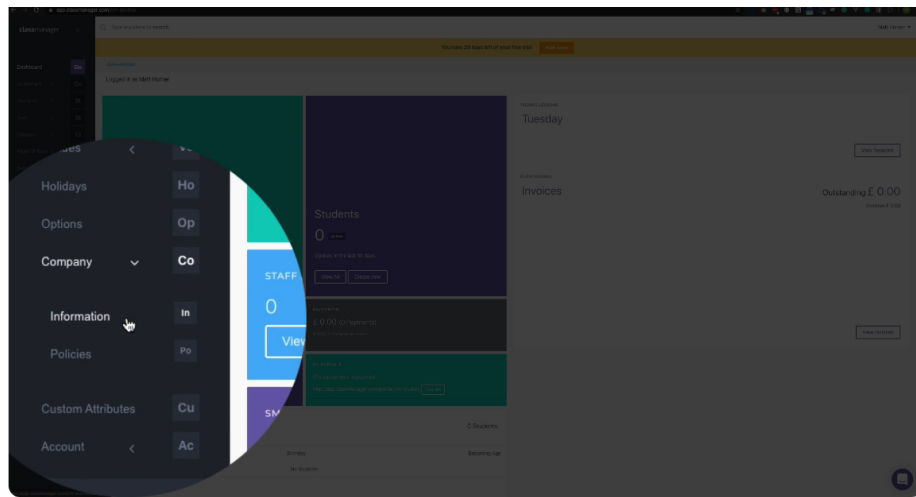
I redesigned the company and client profile setup flows to be more intuitive. Fewer steps, smart defaults, and inline validation reduced friction. These changes helped users complete setup faster and with fewer mistakes. Video walkthroughs and tooltips reinforced confidence and gave users flexibility to return to unfinished steps.

## Creating Customer Profile



## Creating Company Profile



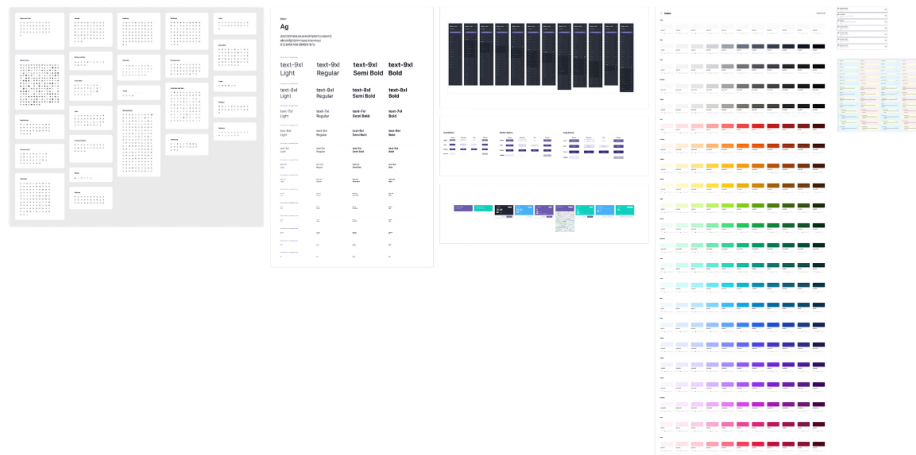


## DESIGN SYSTEM

### Creating a scalable, unified UIKit

I noticed the lack of consistency in UI elements was making navigation confusing and slowing down development. Buttons, forms, and layouts were inconsistent, leading to design inefficiencies and fragmented user experiences.

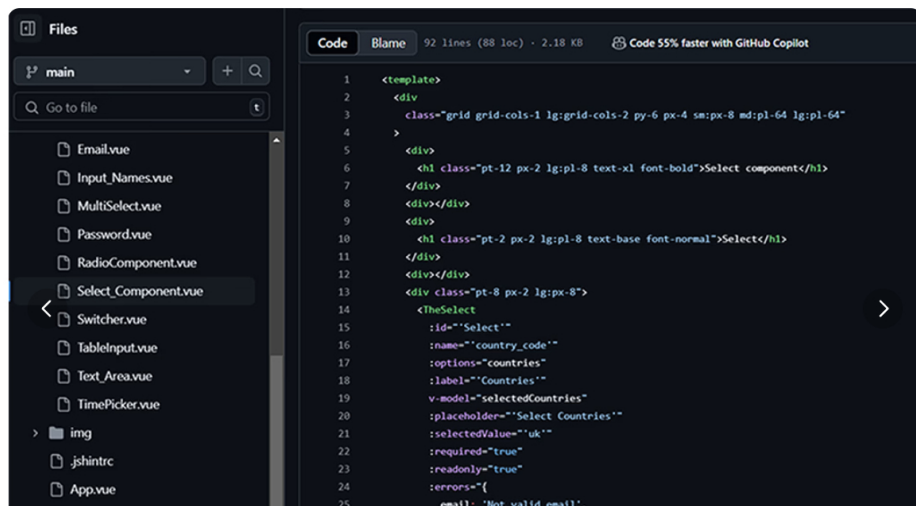
To solve this, I built a scalable UI Kit, deeply integrating Tailwind CSS and Vue.js components to ensure a modular, reusable design system. This provided a unified structure with consistent typography, color palettes, and interactive elements, allowing for faster development, smoother handoffs, and a seamless user experience across web and mobile.



## COMPONENTS

### Engineering design into every detail

Working with the dev team, I helped build a reusable component library in Vue.js and Laravel. This ensured every UI element was modular and maintainable, supporting both custom feature rollouts and rapid iteration. It also enabled us to keep shipping updates without sacrificing consistency or performance.



```
index.css
main.js
router.js
.gitignore
26     country_code: 'Country code doesn exist',
27   }"
28   :helpText="Select Country"
29   @onSelect="selectedCountry"
30   :multiple="false"
```

## FEEDBACK

### What our users had to say

After redesigning ClassManager, the impact was immediate – business owners who once struggled with clunky workflows and time-consuming admin tasks now found the platform effortless and intuitive. Users shared how scheduling, invoicing, and enrolling students, which used to be a hassle, became smooth and efficient, cutting their admin time in half. The frustration of navigating complex interfaces was replaced with a user-friendly experience that allowed them to focus on what truly mattered – teaching and growing their business.

Many expressed how they wished they had switched to ClassManager sooner, highlighting how the new automation features and improved navigation made everyday operations easier. Support tickets dropped as users could now intuitively manage their studios without confusion. With a system that was finally built for them, not against them, business owners could run their operations with confidence, knowing everything just worked.

 **Ali Foy** recommends **Class Manager**.

I have been using Class Manager for my two dance studios for over a year now, and absolutely LOVE it. So easy to use and very affordable. Planning, enrolling & Invoicing is such a breeze! They are always taking on user feedback and constantly adding new features and improvements. Couldn't be happier.

 Like  Comment  Share

 **Anita Arora** recommends **Class Manager**.

Simple and easy software to use. Good price. Best of all, all of questions which almost always get answered straight away.

 Like  Comment

## LESSONS

### Key takeaways from the journey

One of the most valuable takeaways from this project was the impact of direct user feedback at every stage. Talking to actual users early on helped uncover not just interface problems, but also business logic gaps that weren't initially apparent. I also learned the importance of collaboration with developers during the prototyping phase, small layout decisions sometimes needed adjustment based on engineering constraints, and early communication helped avoid costly rework.

## NEXT STEPS

### Where I'd take the product from here

With the success of the redesign and positive user feedback, the next phase focused on refining the experience and expanding capabilities. In the short term, we addressed minor UI tweaks, optimized system performance, and resolved lingering bugs to ensure a seamless experience. As user engagement grew, we prioritized feature enhancements like automated reminders, improved reporting, and a more personalized onboarding experience to further reduce admin time for business owners.

Looking ahead, our long-term vision aimed to scale ClassManager into new markets and user segments, exploring AI-powered automation, deeper integrations with third-party tools, and a mobile-first strategy to support on-the-go management. To sustain growth, we planned to continuously test and refine the platform, ensuring that each update aligned with business goals and real user needs.

## Explore more case studies

**Roam - Mobile App**  
Decentralized Wi-Fi and Rewards App.

**Stage Stubs**  
Event Ticketing Platform

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Oleksii Tatarko

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